

Tips and hints

Throughout the book, you'll find colored boxes offering extra information and useful, practical advice and tips.

Blue boxes offer **TEEN HINTS** with reassurance and helpful suggestions. Parents may want to read them to better understand a teen's point of view.

MYTH BUSTER

The truth about smoking

It doesn't look cool. It also comes with bad breath, stinky hair, and a reduced sense of taste.

It won't help you fit in. Never feel that you have to do something dangerous to fit in with friends.

You won't just be able to have one or two. Research suggests that the brains of young people are more vulnerable to nicotine addiction than adults, so even one or two is enough to develop an addiction.

Yellow factboxes are **MYTH BUSTERS** that clarify misconceptions and provide the facts.

GOOD TO KNOW

Good and bad stress

Stress can sometimes be very useful, as it motivates people to keep working under pressure and energizes them to complete tasks they care about. But if it becomes overwhelming, stress can limit a person's ability to function effectively. When you're feeling stressed, try to use it as motivation to tackle a challenge, but if things start to seem unmanageable, seek support.

Green **GOOD TO KNOW** boxes provide interesting background information.

TEEN HINTS

Family structures

Sometimes a family structure can change due to a separation, divorce, death, or new marriage, for example. Finding your way in a new family structure can be hard, especially when what was your "normal" has been unexpectedly altered. But change often brings the opportunity to form relationships with new people. These people will never replace the people in your old family structure, but will help you to form, and be a part of developing, a new family structure.

PARENT TIPS

Signs of cyberbullying

Many of the signs are similar to those of regular bullying, but may be intensified by electronic devices.

- The way a teen uses their devices might change, such as suddenly not using them, being secretive when using them, or being online obsessively.
- A teen's behavior might change. They might become sad or withdrawn, lash out, or be reluctant to do things they usually enjoy.

Purple boxes give **PARENT TIPS** and offer practical advice on how to support teens. Teens themselves may want to read them to better understand an adult's point of view.

Orange factboxes are **ALERT!** features. These deal with legal issues or risky situations.

ALERT!

Dangerous selfies

Selfies of people in precarious positions have become widespread on social media. Across the world, creating daredevil selfies is putting people's lives at risk. With teens more prone to risk-taking due to the changes that are taking place in their brains, it is important that they don't buy in to this dangerous trend, in which people have been injured. Instead, a person should be aware and ensure that they're safe before taking a selfie.

Starting conversations

We hope this book will help tweens and teens and their parents understand each other a little more. Many pages suggest ways of initiating conversations, listening to each other, and seeing one another's point of view. These tools will help mold confident, happy teens.

This book is a starting point, but it can't answer every question. Each topic also has suggested cross-references, because many aspects of puberty and adolescence are closely linked to one another. At the end of the book, there are **Find out more** pages with suggestions on where get further information and support.

